

16 – Questionnaire Answers

Readable companion to the Requirements Clarification Questionnaire (doc 15)

Every question in the clarification questionnaire, answered as finally resolved. Read this beside the questionnaire itself (doc 15), which carries the full question texts and the reasoning for asking. For the audit trail from each answer to its requirement and decision IDs, see docs 08 (traceability) and 09 (decisions log). Where an answer is marked open, doc 10 tracks it.

Before reading: how the model evolved after the questionnaire

The questionnaire was drafted early, and four of its framings were superseded by what stakeholders subsequently clarified. Reading the answers requires knowing these shifts:

- **One structure, not two parties:** the questionnaire speaks of “central and shops” as a two-party structure. The real structure is four tiers: COOPFED at the apex, ~75 distributors (themselves large MPCs), ~800 MPCs, and shops — and a shop is a location of its MPCs or distributor, not a legal entity. Questions asked about “a shop” are answered at the legally correct level, usually the MPCs.
- **Firm sale won:** A-01 resolved as firm sale, with ownership and risk transferring at GRN confirmation. Consignment appears in the questionnaire as a live option; it is not.
- **No members:** K-01 resolved as no — cooperative membership is entirely out of scope. The system knows “registered customers” (a retail-credit concept) instead of members.
- **SVAT is gone:** SVAT, listed in the tax questions, was abolished with effect from 1 October 2025. Only standard VAT exists in the design.

The eight gating questions

Ref	Gating decision	Resolution
A-01	Firm sale or consignment	Firm sale; ownership and risk at GRN confirmation
B-01	SKU definition level	Smallest tracked item; global namespace, owner + status, flexible attribute rule
B-02	Case vs single	One SKU + UOM conversion; a repack recipe only where a genuinely new item results
M-01	Data ownership	Joint, in substance; legal opinion and data-governance agreement in progress
J-01	Full accounting or AR/AP	AR/AP documents only — no statutory accounting, ever, in this system
H-01	Longest offline period	1–2 days trading fully offline; paper + retrospective entry beyond
K-01	Members distinguished at POS	No — membership out of scope; registered customers only
S-03	Phased release	Yes — three phases, three waves, pilot go/no-go gate

Section A — Commercial and ownership model

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
A-01	Firm sale or consignment?	Firm sale. Ownership passes to the receiving entity at the moment its GRN is confirmed — not at dispatch, not at sale to the end customer. Consignment was considered and rejected. (ADR-03)
A-02	Does the model differ by category?	No. One global rule for all product categories; no per-lot ownership flag.
A-03	When does risk of loss transfer?	With ownership, at GRN signature. In-transit damage and theft are the dispatching entity's loss.
A-04	May a buyer decline or return stock?	The receiver records what actually arrived (may differ from dispatch note); disputes go through the discrepancy and claim workflows leading to credit notes. Return terms are bilateral between the trading entities.
A-05	Return conditions?	Not standardised system-wide; each trading relationship agrees its own terms. The system records claims, inspections, returns and the resulting credit notes.
A-06	At what price do buyers buy?	Federation sells to distributors at one uniform price list plus permitted, permission-gated manual adjustments (special discounts, delivery fees) per order.
A-07	Single price list or varied?	Varies by tier: Federation → distributor is uniform; distributor → MPCs prices are individually negotiated and volume-tiered. Every trading relationship carries its own effective-dated price list.
A-08	May entities buy outside?	Yes — open-market sourcing is permitted at every tier. The system records those goods as local/outside supply.
A-09	Payment terms?	Credit trading is normal. The system records payment-receipt documents only; it never processes or enforces payment. (ADR-01)
A-10	Credit limit: block or warn?	Warn, never block. Exposure is computed from manually recorded receipts and is informative, not authoritative. (ADR-12)
A-11	Who overrides credit blocks?	No blocks exist to override. Credit-limit changes themselves are permission-gated and audit-logged.
A-12	Interest on overdue balances?	Supported as a configurable default rule with manual, role-permissioned override. Automated calculation is deferred until accounting integration.
A-13	Minimum volume obligations?	None. Out of scope.

Section B — SKU definition and product master data

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
B-01	At what level is a SKU defined?	The smallest distinctly tracked and counted item, in one global namespace. Each SKU carries an owning entity and a status (draft → local → shared). Codes are system-generated and meaningless; an English short name is mandatory. The precise attribute rule stays flexible by design.
B-02	Is a case a separate SKU?	Depends on the physical reality. Factory case ↔ single of the same item = one SKU with a UOM conversion factor. Bulk transformed into a genuinely different retail item = a second SKU created through a repack recipe. (ADR-07)
B-03	Two suppliers, one SKU or two?	Left open per product; the owning entity decides. Batch-level supplier attribution preserves traceability either way.
B-04	Batch attributes?	Yes — batch (not SKU) carries cost, supplier, MRP and expiry. Batch/expiry tracking applies only to categories that need it. MRP being a batch attribute is a key decision: two concurrent batches may legally carry different MRPs. (ADR-08)
B-05	Serialised items?	No serialisation anywhere.
B-06	Loose and weighed goods?	Sold by weight against the same SKU priced per kilogram. Bulk-to-pack conversion uses a repack recipe whose expected yield accounts for natural loss, so variance is measured against expectation rather than polluting shrinkage.
B-07	Who creates SKUs?	Federation stewards the shared catalogue; creation is RBAC-controlled.
B-08	May a shop create local SKUs?	The MPCS (or distributor) may — shops are locations, not entities. Local SKUs live in the same global namespace with local status.
B-09	Separate numbering range for local SKUs?	No separate ranges — one namespace; the owner and status fields do the work. Visibility follows the Section M matrix.
B-10	Promoting a local SKU?	A promote-to-shared flow with an alias mapping preserves the originating entity's sales history unbroken. (FR-SKU-100)
B-11	Barcode reliability?	Not guaranteed. Where a label printer exists, weigh stations print GS1 20–29-prefix stickers; otherwise the cashier keys weight against the per-kg price. Code lookup at the till covers unbarcoded items.
B-12	Multiple barcodes per SKU?	Yes — many-to-one is native.
B-13	UOM conversions, who defines?	Per SKU; entities are independent and free to sell in any unit they choose.
B-14	Trilingual master data?	Federation SKUs carry all three languages; local SKUs may carry one or two. English short name is always mandatory (it is the universal fallback). The federation must name a catalogue data steward — still open, and the top schedule risk (T-03).
B-15	Category hierarchy?	No mandatory hierarchy. A governed tag vocabulary provides grouping without forcing one tree on independent entities.
B-16	Restricted / age-controlled items?	Not relevant for now; out of scope.
B-17	Deactivation while stock remains?	Not needed now; parked.

Section C — Requisition, allocation and fulfilment

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
C-01	What triggers a requisition?	Both manual entry and system suggestions from reorder points and sales history.
C-02	Approval of requisitions?	The selling entity approves manually before fulfilment; multi-role approval is supported. No auto-fulfilment.
C-03	Shortfall allocation rule?	First come, first served by default, with manual override. Configurable per selling entity.
C-04	Is the rule configurable?	Yes, per selling entity; changes are audit-logged.
C-05	Partial fulfilment?	Yes. The unfulfilled remainder stays open as a backorder unless explicitly cancelled.
C-06	Minimum order quantity/value?	None required.
C-07	Fixed ordering cycle?	No — ad hoc ordering at any time.
C-08	Amend/cancel window?	Orders lock at a configurable window before the committed ETA (seller policy, per-order override by permitted role).
C-09	Emergency requests?	Handled manually; no separate system path.
C-10	Lateral transfers between shops?	Within one MPCS only, mediated and approved by the MPCS — shops never see sibling stock directly. Between entities, a “transfer” is simply a normal sale.
C-11	Lateral transfer price/approval?	MPCS approves its internal transfers; they move at cost with no invoice. Federation is not involved.
C-12	Stock visibility before ordering?	Yes — a buyer sees the seller’s availability (live or indicative, seller’s choice).
C-13	Committed lead time?	An indicative ETA is set at acceptance and delivery performance is measured against it.

Section D — Delivery, goods receipt and discrepancies

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
D-01	Who delivers?	Sellers’ own fleets. Vehicle operations are outside system scope; vehicle, driver and timestamps are recorded on documents.
D-02	Multi-shop routes?	Yes. One delivery note can cover multiple drop points from one vehicle (the direct-drop pattern).
D-03	Proof of delivery?	Both a driver mobile app and signed paper are supported.
D-04	Count on receipt?	The receiver counts and records actuals — receipts are never forced to match the dispatch note.
D-05	Quantity differs from dispatched?	The system records what actually arrived and automatically raises a discrepancy for investigation. (FR-DEL-030/040)
D-06	Who investigates discrepancies?	The two trading parties, within an agreed time limit; the federation is the fall-back arbiter if unresolved.
D-07	Damage credit timing?	After inspection and approval — never automatic on receipt.
D-08	Photograph evidence?	Yes, attachable to discrepancy and claim records. (FR-DEL-050)
D-09	Vehicle/driver/timestamp?	Recorded.
D-10	Returnable containers?	Not tracked; out of scope.

Section E — Inventory management

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
E-01	Warehouses?	Federation operates multiple warehouses; stock moves between them as internal transfers.
E-02	Shelf vs back-store split?	Not tracked; a shop is one stock location.
E-03	Costing method?	Weighted average, set as an entity-level accounting policy with no per-transaction override (IAS 2 aligned).
E-04	FIFO or FEFO?	FEFO assumed for expiry-relevant batch-tracked goods, with manual override.
E-05	Count frequency?	Manual scheduling by each entity; cycle counting supported (ABC prioritisation arrives P2).
E-06	Trade during counts?	The entity's own operational choice; the system supports both.
E-07	Adjustment approval?	MPCS chairman/accountant (or configured approver), escalated by variance value thresholds per SKU or tag.
E-08	Reorder point calculation?	System-calculated per shop and SKU, reviewable and overridable. (P2)
E-09	Negative stock?	Permitted with explicit cashier acknowledgement; every occurrence lands on the exception report. Blocking would stop genuine sales whenever records are wrong.
E-10	Cold chain tracking?	Handled physically (refrigerated vehicles); not system-tracked.
E-11	Stock ageing?	Reported with warnings. (P2)

Section F — Damages, discards, expiry and shrinkage

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
F-01	Loss categories?	Recorded separately: damaged in transit, damaged in store, expired, theft, shrinkage, staff consumption, samples, donation, other. Never one generic adjustment. (FR-LOSS-010)
F-02	Who bears each loss?	Whichever entity owned the goods at the moment of loss — a direct consequence of the firm-sale/GRN answer to A-01.
F-03	Returns for credit?	Yes, via the claim workflow: raise with photos, inspect, approve, credit note.
F-04	Write-off approval?	Role/permission-based, varying by value.
F-05	Witness and verification?	Required: a witness distinct from the requester, photographic evidence where practical, and requester ≠ approver enforced. Write-off is the highest-fraud-risk lifecycle in the system.
F-06	Expiry alerts?	Batch-level warning windows by category; entering the window generates a count task for the holding shop.
F-07	Markdown selling?	Yes, through the discount/markdown rule engine (days-to-expiry trigger), stamped with its rule ID so the cost of over-ordering is measurable separately from ordinary promotion.
F-08	Disposal certificates?	Not required.
F-09	Shrinkage percentage visibility?	Reported per shop; Federation sees it (full view-only visibility per Section M).
F-10	Loss tolerances?	Configurable threshold per SKU or SKU group below which no escalation occurs.
F-11	Damaged-but-saleable?	Handled as a markdown rule rather than a separate stock state.

Section G — Pricing

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
G-01	Who sets retail price?	Each MPCS sets one retail list for all its shops. Federation may publish recommended prices — advisory only.
G-02	May a shop deviate?	Never. Shops have no standing price deviation; any per-bill reduction comes only from an authored rule.
G-03	Government MRP ceilings?	Enforced as a hard control, validated against the MRP of the specific batch being sold; controlled-price history is retained via effective-dated, batch-level records.
G-04	Member prices?	None. No member or loyalty pricing exists (see Section K).
G-05	Promotions?	Yes — time-limited reductions, quantity offers, bill-level and free-item benefits, all expressed as rules.
G-06	Who funds promotions?	The MPCS decides and funds its own promotions. No cross-entity promotional settlement in phase 1.
G-07	Manual till discounts?	No — this earlier allowance was formally rescinded. There is no discretionary discount function at any till; the rule engine is the sole mechanism for any price reduction. (ADR-14)
G-08	Scheduled price changes?	Dropped for now. Price list changes apply on propagation; discount/markdown rules do carry validity windows.
G-09	Tax-inclusive pricing?	Yes, uniformly — shelf and receipt prices include tax, computed from per-SKU tax categories.
G-10	Rounding?	Cash tenders round to the nearest rupee; card and account tenders settle exact.

Section H — Point of sale and offline operation

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
H-01	Longest offline period?	One to two days through power cuts and outages, with paper procedures plus retrospective entry beyond that. This drove the full local-database till design.
H-02	What works offline?	Cash sale, receipt printing, stock deduction, price and rule lookup, park/resume, same-till same-session refund, GRN capture, cached role permissions.
H-03	What is blocked offline?	New orders, card/wallet/QR tender, master-data changes, cross-till or cross-day refunds, payment-receipt posting. Write-offs are captured as drafts for online approval.
H-04	Conflict resolution?	Designed out rather than solved: every record type has exactly one writer (the till for its own sale events; central for catalogue and prices, pushed read-only). No merge logic exists. (ADR-10)
H-05	Card payments offline?	Cash only while offline. Cards run on standalone bank terminals; the system records tender type and reference only and never touches card data. (ADR-19)
H-06	Till lanes per shop?	Varies by shop size; ~1.5 tills/shop average is the planning figure. The shop-size mix is an open data item for rollout planning.
H-07	Peripherals?	Scanner, receipt printer, cash drawer, weighing scale, customer display, card terminal (standalone), label printer where present — all behind a hardware abstraction layer.
H-08	Hardware platform?	Dedicated POS terminals, all new hardware, centrally specified. (Direction as of this document: ARM/Android terminals — being finalised in technical design.)
H-09	Receipt language?	Per shop, with English fallback for missing translations.
H-10	Refund/void authorisation?	Role-based: same-till same-session at cashier level; anything wider needs supervisor and connectivity.
H-11	Parked sales?	Supported — park and resume.
H-12	Peak volumes?	No hard historical stats exist (paper operation). The adopted planning envelope: ~3 million transactions/day federation-wide at the 10,000-shop horizon.
H-13	Cashier attribution?	Every sale is attributed to the authenticated operator.
H-14	Home delivery / online ordering?	Not now; parked for a later phase.

Section I — Payments, cash and settlement

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
I-01	Tender types?	All recorded, none processed: cash, card, wallet, customer credit account, voucher, subsidy instrument (later phases for the last two).
I-02	Customer credit accounts?	Yes — the khata book digitised: per-MPCS accounts with limit, balance, repayments and ageing. Frequently the largest receivable a society carries.
I-03	Till cash management?	Full: opening float, cash drops, blind close, variance reporting.
I-04	Banking reconciliation?	Banking of takings is recorded; reconciliation automation follows accounting integration.
I-05	How do entities settle?	Cash/bank deposit at shop → MPCS level (internal); cheque and deposit between entities. All recorded as payment-receipt documents by the seller.
I-06	Statements of account?	Yes, per relationship, at configured frequency.
I-07	Payment matching?	Matched to specific invoices, never oldest-first — this is what makes ageing and dispute handling meaningful.
I-08	Foreign currency?	Federation only, for import procurement (landed cost, P2).

Section J — Inter-entity billing and accounting

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
J-01	Full accounting per entity?	No — the largest scope decision in the programme. The system manages trading documents and the receivable/payable picture between entities; statutory books stay in each society's own arrangements, with an accounting system integrating later. (ADR-05)
J-02	Export format?	Every document type carries a designed journal-posting mapping, so integration is a mapping exercise. Concrete formats are decided when the accounting system is chosen.
J-03	Tax regime?	Standard VAT only. All chain entities are VAT-registered; registration is a per-entity attribute; tax invoices carry both parties' numbers. SVAT was abolished effective 1 Oct 2025 — no SVAT flow exists.
J-04	E-invoicing mandated?	Expected near-term but not yet specified by IRD. Readiness is built in (immutable invoices, disciplined numbering, reserved integration point); live integration is deferred to P3.
J-05	Numbering rules?	Sequential and gapless, per series: till-issued documents number from a per-till-position series with a locally persisted counter; back-office documents from per-entity, per-document-type series. Numbers are final at issuance and never reused; voids keep their numbers. Note: the questionnaire's suggestion of pre-reserved number ranges was evaluated and formally rejected. The design is with stakeholders as an RFC. (ADR-11)
J-06	Retention period?	Indefinite, pending a formal retention policy.
J-07	Credit/debit notes?	Required and supported at all tiers.
J-08	Financial year differences?	None — one common financial year across all entities.
J-09	Auditor access?	Entity-scoped read-only for each society's auditors; Federation auditors see all entities view-only; defined transaction listings supported.

Section K — Membership and patronage

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
K-01	Distinguish members at POS?	No — and this dissolves most of Section K. Cooperative membership, shares, patronage and governance are entirely out of scope. What exists instead is the “registered customer”: a retail-credit concept unrelated to co-op membership. (ADR-16)
K-02	Member register scope?	For registered customers: one global identity (internal ID; phone is a lookup attribute with audited changes and reuse detection), with a separate account per MPCs the customer trades with. (ADR-15)
K-03	Preferential prices?	Per-customer preferential pricing arrives in phase 3, configured by each MPCs.
K-04	Patronage rebates?	Out of scope — accounting/governance territory.
K-05	Share capital?	Out of scope.
K-06	Member loans?	Out of scope (customer trade credit exists; loans do not).
K-07	AGM/governance functions?	Out of scope.
K-08	Personal data held?	Minimal PII: name and phone; NIC optional and only where credit is granted. PDPA-compliant by design ahead of enforcement. (ADR-27)

Section L — Central procurement and supplier management

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
L-01	Central procurement in scope?	Yes, phase 2: market price intelligence per SKU by source (importer, supplier, Pettah survey).
L-02	Demand forecasting?	Yes, phase 2, by region/season/product — one of the core arguments for the system. Price forecasting remains a scenario tool only, never an automated decision-maker.
L-03	Supplier contracts?	Managed in-system: contracts, agreed prices, volume commitments. (P2)
L-04	Tender/quotation process?	A quotation register with full audit trail: RFQs, invited suppliers, recorded quotes, comparison, permission-gated award. No public portal. (P2)
L-05	Landed cost?	Calculated (duty, freight, clearing apportioned across shipment lines) and carried as the batch cost of imported goods — flowing straight into the costing model. (P2)
L-06	Central repacking?	Federation repacking is expected later; it reuses the same recipe mechanism as MPCs repacking and is enabled by a permission flip. (P3)
L-07	Supplier performance?	Fill rate, lead time and rejection rate derived from PO-versus-GRN data. (P2)

Section M — Data ownership, visibility and governance

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
M-01	Who owns shop data?	Jointly, in substance — Federation and societies act as joint controllers. A Co-operative Act legal opinion is pending, and a written data-governance agreement (none exists today) is flagged as near-mandatory to draft alongside the build. (ADR-26)
M-02	Central sees non-central goods?	Yes. Federation sees everything, view-only — including sales of goods it did not supply.
M-03	Central sees local suppliers?	Yes, view-only.
M-04	Central sees margins/shrinkage?	Yes, view-only. T-02 (societies accept central visibility) was confirmed affirmatively.
M-05	Shop-to-shop visibility?	None. A shop sees nothing of its siblings; the MPCS mediates lateral needs. (This supersedes the earlier C-10 framing.)
M-06	Anonymised aggregate tier?	Not needed — full visibility made the compromise tier redundant.
M-07	If a society leaves?	It cannot — societies cannot leave the federation. Historical data is retained indefinitely.
M-08	Who administers users?	Each entity self-administers. An MPCS additionally administers its shops' users. Federation holds no downward admin — accepted consequence: the helpdesk cannot reset an MPCS user's password. (ADR-18)
M-09	Privacy obligations?	PDPA (No. 9 of 2022, as amended) applies; a responsible officer is named per entity; the system is built compliant ahead of the substantive provisions' commencement.
M-10	Regulator access?	The Department of Co-operative Development receives an external, time-bound, read-only role; every grant is audit-logged. No prescribed return formats exist.
M-11	Data sharing agreement?	Does not exist — drafting it is a named legal deliverable running parallel to the build.

Section N — Security, roles and internal controls

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
N-01	Shop roles?	A default template set (cashier, supervisor, accountant, GM/chairman and others — doc 07 lists fourteen) on top of a dynamic permission catalogue and role builder, so entities can shape their own roles. (FR-SEC-010)
N-02	Central roles?	Federation procurement, marketing, accounts, admin, auditors, NOC/support bridge, helpdesk — same dynamic RBAC.
N-03	Till authentication?	Short numeric PIN per operator — fast enough that logins are not shared. Back office uses passwords.
N-04	MFA?	Required (TOTP) for financial and administrative back-office functions; those functions are online-only.
N-05	Immutable audit trail?	Yes, append-only, covering the full event catalogue in doc 07 §3: overrides, voids, refunds, write-offs, adjustments, role changes, series registrations, sync anomalies, regulator grants. Hash-chaining is a P2 hardening.
N-06	Exception reports?	Required with named reviewers; the concrete list is finalised in the pending report-catalogue workshop.
N-07	Segregation of duties?	Enforced where specified — the canonical case: a write-off requester may not approve it.
N-08	Departing staff?	Accounts are deactivated, never deleted; history is retained.
N-09	Physical security at shops?	Idle locks (till 2–3 min, back office 10–15, admin 5), operator attribution on every action, and drawer-open-without-sale as an audited event.

Section O — Reporting and analytics

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
O-01	What decisions drive reports?	The catalogue is decision-driven rather than a screen list; a finalisation workshop with stakeholders is pending. Doc 07 §5 holds the current placeholder set.
O-02	Offline reporting?	Z-report, day-sales summary and till-session report print on the local thermal printer with no connectivity.
O-03	Real-time or end-of-day?	Near-real-time operational dashboards from the event stream, heavy aggregates end-of-day — and every federation-level report carries a per-entity data-freshness stamp, because some shops are always offline.
O-04	Statutory return formats?	None prescribed by the Co-operative Department.
O-05	Exports and self-service?	Spreadsheet export: yes, phase 1. A self-service report builder: backlog, deliberately.
O-06	Mobile dashboards?	Backlog; the responsive web back office covers browser access on phones.
O-07	History retention?	Indefinite — trends remain comparable across years by design.

Section P — Language, localisation and accessibility

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
P-01	Full trilingual interface?	Yes — interface, printed documents, and search all trilingual, phase 1.
P-02	Language per user or shop?	Per shop, with English fallback wherever a translation is missing.
P-03	Trilingual reports?	Printed customer-facing output follows the shop language; the shared A4 pipeline renders all catalogue reports.
P-04	Search and sort in Sinhala/Tamil?	Yes — correct collation via Unicode/ICU is a phase-1 requirement; OpenSearch-backed search analysis arrives P2.
P-05	Fonts on thermal printers?	Noto (or equivalent) fonts; receipts render through the platform text stack and print as raster, which solves Sinhala/Tamil shaping on low-cost printers.
P-06	Input methods?	Sinhala/Tamil input provisioned per shop at onboarding (config register item).
P-07	Authoritative language?	English — it is the mandatory universal field and the fallback everywhere.
P-08	Literacy/accessibility?	Addressed by the usability directive: screens mirror familiar paper documents, role-scoped and icon-led, with a training/sandbox mode.
P-09	Date/number formats?	Consistent formatting across all three languages via ICU.

Section Q — Infrastructure, hosting and service levels

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
Q-01	Cloud or on-premises?	Cloud. No legal data-residency constraint was identified (government IT policy check still pending as a legal action). Provider and sizing specifics live in doc 14 — Technical Foundations.
Q-02	Who operates it?	An in-house team; the architecture is deliberately shaped for a single-DevOps-engineer operating model (modular monolith, managed services). (ADR-20)
Q-03	RTO / RPO?	Central: recovery within 4–8 hours, data loss ≤ 15 minutes. The edge is stronger by construction — shops trade through multi-day central outages. (ADR-21)
Q-04	Availability / SLA?	24×7 trading capability with no scheduled downtime window; rolling updates. Support: extended trading hours plus on-call (a Federation cost decision, still open between this and full 24×7).
Q-05	Five-year growth?	The stakeholder-confirmed envelope: 10,000 shops within three years (≈15,000 tills), 12,000 shops at five years, ≈3M transactions/day. (ADR-22)
Q-06	Connectivity per shop?	Each society pays for its own connections (ADR-25); a minimum spec (≈2 Mbps down / 0.5 up, router-based) is a go-live gate per site.
Q-07	Power reliability?	A known problem — hence battery-backed till hardware, safe-shutdown local database design, and offline-first operation.
Q-08	Existing standards to fit?	None found; the government IT policy check remains an open legal item.
Q-09	Support model?	Trilingual helpdesk on extended hours + on-call escalation; ratio-based staffing that scales with the fleet. Boundaries: no connectivity troubleshooting, no MPCS password resets.
Q-10	Update deferral?	No indefinite deferral. Signed packages, ring deployment, automatic install outside each shop's trading hours, a server-enforced minimum version floor with a grace period. (ADR-24)

Section R — Existing systems, data migration and integration

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
R-01	Existing POS to extract from?	None — the federation runs entirely on paper. Nothing to extract or integrate.
R-02	What data migrates?	Opening balances only: stock counts at onboarding, plus any customer/khata balances entered as signed two-party opening-balance documents. No historical sales migration.
R-03	Where does master data live?	Paper and scattered spreadsheets. Assembling the trusted catalogue is the T-03 critical path; the Federation must name its data steward.
R-04	Data cleanliness?	Cleansing is budgeted as a named workstream with its own owner (to be appointed) — it cannot be absorbed by the software team.
R-05	Bank integration?	None — documents, not payments. (ADR-01)
R-06	Government portal integration?	None now; IRD e-invoicing readiness is designed in for when the mandate arrives.
R-07	API for future integrations?	Yes — OpenAPI-specified, OAuth2/OIDC-secured; the accounting system is the first expected consumer.
R-08	SMS/email notifications?	Configurable notifications (dispatch alerts, statements) are in scope.
R-09	Existing devices to support?	None to inherit — hardware is new and centrally specified. (T-07 confirmed)

Section S — Programme, rollout and change management

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
S-01	How many shops, where?	≈4,000 today across all 25 districts, growing to ≈10,000 within three years of go-live. Where the growth comes from (MPCS expansion vs new societies) is an open Federation question.
S-02	Staff and computer familiarity?	Generally low familiarity — addressed by the usability directive, trilingual regional training against a standard playbook, and the sandbox mode.
S-03	Phased release acceptable?	Yes — three functional phases against three geographic waves, with a go/no-go gate at end of pilot (≈40% of spend). (ADR-23)
S-04	Decision authority?	Federation admins hold sign-off; the requirements baseline freezes on their written approval, then change control applies. Decision speed (T-01) remains the top programme risk.
S-05	Adoption voluntary?	Compulsory per rollout wave — the system does not need to handle partial voluntary coverage.
S-06	Target go-live date?	Deliberately not stated in any document; wave planning avoids festival and harvest peaks.
S-07	Training delivery?	Regionally, in all three languages, per the standard onboarding playbook (~40 shops/week as a standing productised function).
S-08	Funding model?	Central budget. Per-shop usage fees are not modelled; no usage metering requirement exists.
S-09	Post-go-live ownership?	Federation owns prioritisation and arbitration between societies, under the same change-control discipline as the baseline.
S-10	Twelve-month success measures?	Not yet defined — an open programme item to be agreed before build sign-off.

Section T — Risks and assumptions

Ref	Question (abridged)	Answer as resolved
T-01	Single binding decisions in time?	Confirmed as the arrangement, and confirmed as the top schedule risk — tracked live in doc 10.
T-02	Societies accept central visibility?	Confirmed yes, fully: Federation sees everything view-only, including margins and shrinkage.
T-03	Catalogue assembled before go-live?	Confirmed as the critical path. The data steward and cleansing owner are still unnamed — the single largest open action.
T-04	Staff trainable at the till?	Confirmed, with the mitigations designed in: paper-mirroring screens, PIN auth, sandbox mode, and prototype validation with real cashiers before build sign-off.
T-05	Connectivity sufficient for daily sync?	Confirmed — the design tolerates 1–2 day gaps, and beyond that paper catch-up procedures apply.
T-06	Existing accounting continues?	Confirmed — the system feeds future accounting; society bookkeeping is untouched.
T-07	Hardware standardised?	Confirmed — centrally specified, all new.